Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 24 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Rain	Rain
16° 8°	14° 7°	13° 8°	12° 4°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Prime Minister is suggesting that households across the UK should consider stocking up on tinned food and bottled water.**

Andy Burnham says unexpected events are becoming more common, and it's a wise move for everyone to be prepared. He's advising families to put together an emergency kit.

POLITICS · UK

2 **A stepfather has been jailed for life after being found guilty of murdering his stepdaughter, following a 'longstanding sexual obsession'.**

Nathan Owens was sentenced after a judge heard about his obsession with Carla Georgescu. The court heard the horrific details of the student's death.

CRIME · UK

3 **A mother has been given an indefinite hospital order after admitting the manslaughter of her three young children.**

Yasmeen Ali, 44, was sentenced after the tragic deaths of her children. The court heard the details of the case, which has shocked the community.

CRIME · UK

4 **Campaigners are challenging Home Office plans to house asylum seekers at a military base in the High Court.**

A judicial review has been sought into the government's proposals for MoD Bicester. Concerns have been raised about the suitability and impact of the plans.

IMMIGRATION · UK

5 **The UK's grid operator has reassured the public that the lights will stay on this winter, despite concerns about energy supply.**

The National Energy System Operator issued the assurance after engineers raised worries about their ability to ensure adequate supply. They've stated measures are in place to maintain stability.

ENERGY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **The final screen tests for the next James Bond are reportedly taking place this weekend, with two British actors in the running.**

Callum Turner and Jack Lowden are said to be among those appearing for the crucial auditions. Fans are eagerly awaiting news of who will be the next 007.

ON AIR — Who do you think would make a brilliant Bond? Or is it time for a completely different kind of spy?

FILM · COMING UP

2 **The Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, is swapping the dispatch box for the sofa in a special charity appearance this weekend.**

He's joining his friend, Liverpool Mayor Steve Rotheram, for a Stand Up To Cancer edition of Gogglebox. It's certainly a different kind of prime ministerial broadcast!

ON AIR — What do you make of the Prime Minister appearing on Gogglebox? Is it a good way to connect with the public?

TV · THIS WEEKEND

3 **Indian singer Anuv Jain is revealing how he found massive success without the usual Bollywood boost.**

The star, known for his unique sound, says he's very selective about releasing new music. He's also shared his hopes for future collaborations, exciting fans.

ON AIR — Have you discovered any brilliant artists who've made it big without the traditional routes? Who should we be listening to?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **Former Little Mix star Jade Thirlwall has described working on a song for the upcoming Blue Planet III as 'magical'.**

She collaborated with legendary composer Hans Zimmer on an official track for the highly anticipated nature documentary. It's a big move for the singer into the world of film scores.

ON AIR — What's your favourite nature documentary soundtrack? Does the music make or break those incredible visuals?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller has made history by giving Wales its first UK number one single in fifteen years!**

His track 'Babydoll' has topped the charts, making him the first Welsh artist since 2011 to achieve the feat. It's a huge moment for Welsh music.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Welsh number one from over the years? Do you remember where you were when you first heard it?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Ferrari's Charles Leclerc has set the pace in the first practice session for the United States Grand Prix in Austin.**

Leclerc was fastest ahead of Red Bull's Max Verstappen, suggesting an exciting weekend of racing. All eyes will be on qualifying later today.

ON AIR — Who are you backing for pole position in Austin? And can anyone stop Verstappen this weekend?

F1 · THIS WEEKEND

2 **English golfers Ian Poulter and Tyrrell Hatton have confirmed they are leaving LIV Golf, continuing an exodus from the breakaway tour.**

Their departure raises further questions about the future of LIV Golf as more star names opt out. It will be interesting to see where they play next.

ON AIR — What do you think this means for the future of professional golf? Is the sport finally finding some stability?

GOLF · UK

3 **Chelsea face Tottenham Hotspur in a highly anticipated London derby this weekend, with chaos often guaranteed when these two meet.**

Premier League bragging rights are on the line as both teams look to climb the table. Past encounters have been packed with drama and talking points.

ON AIR — What's your favourite memory from a Chelsea vs Spurs derby? And who do you think will come out on top this time?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **England's Rugby League team are balancing their points chase with discipline as they face France in the World Cup.**

Winger Matty Ashton stressed the importance of maintaining composure in their second group fixture in Perth on Saturday. They'll be looking for a strong performance.

ON AIR — How do you think England will fare against France? What's the key to a successful Rugby League World Cup campaign?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **Katie Boulter has reclaimed her British number one ranking after fighting back to reach the semi-finals of the Japan Open.**

She beat Antonia Ruzic in a thrilling three-set match, marking a significant return to form. It's a fantastic achievement for the British tennis star.

ON AIR — How important is it for British tennis to have players like Katie Boulter performing well on the world stage? Who are you hoping to see succeed next?

TENNIS · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Many people are discovering the quiet joy of perfectly aligning items in their pantry.**
It's not just about tidiness; some find a real sense of calm and order in seeing jars and packets lined up just so. A little bit of everyday zen, perhaps?

2 **There's a growing appreciation for the unique patterns found in frosted windowpanes on chilly mornings.**
Before they melt away, these natural ice formations offer miniature, ephemeral artworks, reminding us to notice the beauty in passing moments.

3 **The simple act of 'smoothly closing a kitchen drawer' is surprisingly satisfying for many.**
That gentle glide and soft click, especially if it's a well-behaved drawer, offers a small moment of perfection in a busy day.

4 **More people are finding delight in the distinct aroma of freshly baked bread wafting from local bakeries.**
It's a comforting, nostalgic scent that evokes warmth and home, often sparking a pleasant memory or two as you pass by.

5 **The trend of 'perfectly peeling an orange in one continuous spiral' is providing a tiny, gratifying challenge.**
It requires a bit of patience and a steady hand, but the reward is a beautiful, unbroken ribbon of peel – a small victory for your morning fruit.

6 **Research shows that the 'gentle bubbling sound of a kettle coming to boil' can be surprisingly soothing.**
For many, it's a signal of an impending hot cuppa and a moment of pause, offering a tiny dose of relaxation in the daily routine.

7 **A new appreciation is emerging for the subtle shimmer of condensation on a cold glass of water.**
It's a small visual treat, a fleeting, almost artistic effect that reminds us of refreshing moments on a warm day.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A LITTLE SHAKE TO 'FEEL' HOW MANY ARE IN THERE, HOPING FOR A GOOD AMOUNT!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of pickles, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ARRANGING THE FIRST FEW PICKLES PERFECTLY BEFORE TAKING ONE OUT, ENSURING THEY LOOK JUST RIGHT!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel truly happy or content, perhaps a sound from your home or even out and about?**
  What's that one specific, often unnoticed, everyday sound that just brings a little smile to your face, and why does it mean so much to you?

- **We all have that 'one particular, often overlooked feature' in our home that we're surprisingly fond of, don't we? It might be a window, a banister, or even a quirky light switch.**
  What's that little architectural detail or everyday feature in your home that you secretly love, and what makes it special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain there for millions of years because there is no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a secret, special organ that allows them to produce their own brand of sparkling water, which they share with thirsty polar bears.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The official residence of the British monarch in Scotland is Holyroodhouse Palace in Edinburgh.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia micra, is so tiny it can fit on the tip of your finger.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis, located in Scotland.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Nicéphore Niépce.
- The only letter that does not appear in the periodic table is the letter 'J'.
- The 'Crooked House' in Himley, Staffordshire, is famously lopsided due to mining subsidence in the 19th century.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 24 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 297 of the year, 68 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony Mary Claret; Christian feast day: Arethas of Najran; Christian feast day: Eberigisil (Evergitus); Christian feast day: Blessed Giuseppe Baldo. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1951 — George Tsontakis, American composer and conductor
- 1980 — Casey Wilson, American actress and screenwriter
- 1962 — Ian Dalziel, English footballer and manager
- 1947 — Kevin Kline, American actor and singer
- 1968 — Mark Walton, American voice actor and illustrator
- 1995 — Ashton Sanders, American actor
- 1994 — Krystal Jung, American-South Korean singer, dancer, and actress
- 1973 — Jackie McNamara, Scottish footballer and manager

THE DAY TODAY

- 2015 — A driver deliberately crashes into the Oklahoma State Homecoming parade, killing four people and injuring 34.
- 1947 — Famed animator Walt Disney testifies before the House Un-American Activities Committee, naming Disney employees he believes to be communists.
- 2016 — A French surveillance aircraft flying to Libya crashes on takeoff in Malta, killing all five people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2015 — A driver deliberately crashes into the Oklahoma State Homecoming parade, killing four people and injuring 34.
- 1975 — In Iceland, 90% of women take part in a national strike, refusing to work in protest of gender inequality.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — Chang'e 1, the first satellite in the Chinese Lunar Exploration Program, is launched from Xichang Satellite Launch Center.

- 1964 — Northern Rhodesia gains independence from the United Kingdom and becomes Zambia.
- 1960 — Nedelin catastrophe: An R-16 ballistic missile explodes on the launch pad at the Soviet Union's Baikonur Cosmodrome space facility, killing over 100 people, including Field Marshal Mitrofan Nedelin.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 25 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 298 of the year, 67 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Romania); Christian feast day: Bernat Calbó (Bernard of Calvo); Christian feast day: Canna; Christian feast day: Blessed Carlo Gnocchi. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Michael Weston, American actor
- 1978 — Russell Anderson, Scottish footballer
- 1971 — Craig Robinson, American actor and singer
- 1988 — Lewis McGugan, English professional footballer
- 1946 — Peter Lieberson, American composer (died 2011)
- 1981 — Shaun Wright-Phillips, English footballer
- 1979 — Mariana Klaveno, American actress
- 1944 — Donald Ford, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1971 — The People's Republic of China replaces the Republic of China at the United Nations.
- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: Adlai Stevenson shows the United Nations Security Council reconnaissance photographs of Soviet ballistic missiles in Cuba.
- 1990 — The Kazakh Soviet Socialist Republic declares its sovereignty from the Soviet Union.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1968 — A Fairchild F-27 crashes into Moose Mountain while on approach to Lebanon Municipal Airport in Lebanon, New Hampshire, killing 32 people.
- 2009 — The October 2009 Baghdad bombings kill 155 and wound at least 721.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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